

The Monk's Blessing

A **monk** knocked at the door of a wealthy landowner late one night and asked for shelter. It was readily given.

The next morning as the monk was about to leave, his **host** asked him for a **blessing** for the continued **prosperity** of his house.

"Father dies, son dies, grandson dies... let it be so," **intoned** the monk.



"Is that a blessing or a **curse!**" **exclaimed** the householder. "What have I done to **displease** you?"

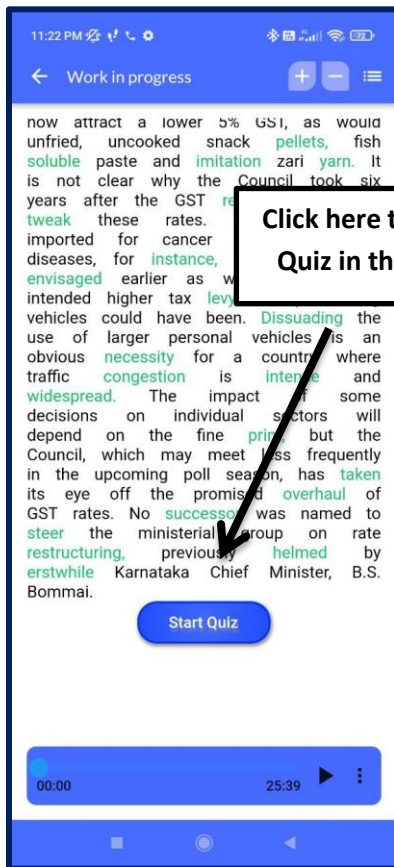
"I am not displeased," replied the monk. "If the son dies before the father or the grandson before the grandfather, the family is **wounded** and prosperity **wanes**. I have prayed for the natural order to **prevail** in your house."

His host **murmured** an **apology** for his **outburst** and **bowed** in **gratitude**.

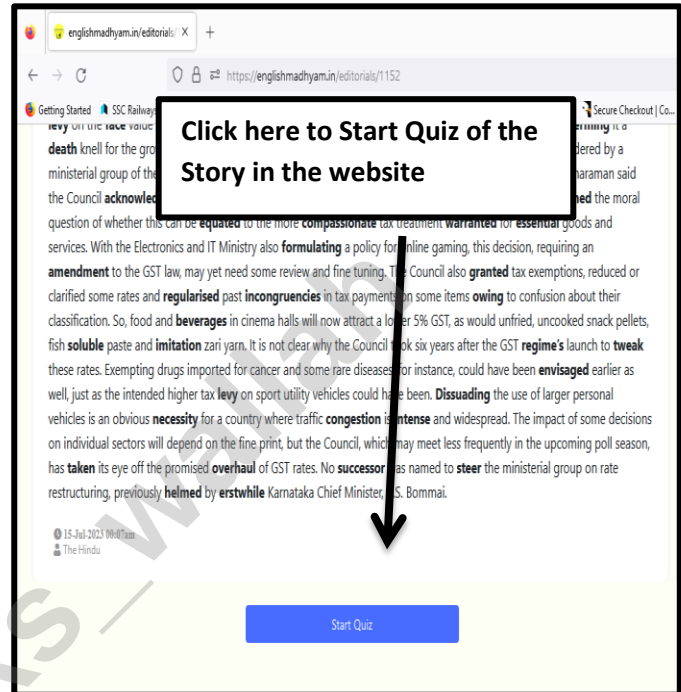
Vocabulary

1. **Monk** (noun) – Ascetic, friar, hermit, recluse, mendicant साधु / सन्यासी
2. **Host** (noun) – Entertainer, innkeeper, landlord, welcomer, patron मेज़बान
3. **Blessing** (noun) – Benediction, favor, grace, boon, prayer आशीर्वाद
4. **Prosperity** (noun) – Success, affluence, wealth, well-being, fortune समृद्धि
5. **Intone** (verb) – Chant, recite, utter, speak, proclaim गाना/गंभीर स्वर में बोलना
6. **Curse** (noun) – Malediction, damnation, hex, jinx, imprecation शाप
7. **Exclaim** (verb) – Cry out, shout, yell, call, ejaculate चिल्लाना/आश्चर्य से बोलना
8. **Displease** (verb) – Annoy, offend, upset, irritate, anger नाराज़ करना
9. **Wound** (verb) – Hurt, injure, damage, harm, bruise चोट पहुँचाना
10. **Wane** (verb) – Decline, diminish, fade, lessen, weaken कम होना
11. **Prevail** (verb) – Succeed, triumph, dominate, reign, overcome प्रबल होना/जीतना
12. **Murmur** (verb) – Whisper, mutter, mumble, sigh, grumble बड़बड़ाना
13. **Apology** (noun) – Regret, excuse, confession, admission, repentance माफी
14. **Outburst** (noun) – Eruption, explosion, flare-up, burst, spasm उफान/भावनात्मक विस्फोट
15. **Bow** (verb) – Bend, incline, stoop, nod, curtsy झुकना
16. **Gratitude** (noun) – Thankfulness, appreciation, gratefulness, recognition, indebtedness आभार

Practice Exercise



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